the committee received five to ten complaints/petitions per week on average. Most came from Yangon and Mandalay and were mainly about unfair judicial verdicts in civil and criminal cases, and power abuse by local authorities.[22] The committee had no executive power to deal with them and it had to forward the complaints to the respective government agencies. However, the committee was effective in following up on these issues and could pressure the executive to respond to them.

Everything depends on the speakers

The speakers' absolute power is important in understanding the Hluttaw characteristics in responding to conflict. In established democracies, little importance is given to the role of the speaker.[23] The emphasis is on the leader of the ruling/majority party or the opposition/minority partly. But in Myanmar, the speaker has additional powers: (i) he can call for and adjourn plenary sessions at his own discretion; (ii) every motion and question needs his prior approval; (iii) his decision is final and cannot be protested; and (iv) he has control over the voting method.[24] Not only does he bring order, he also directs and controls the pace of the legislature. Thus, Myanmar's speakers are not just conductors, but also commanders.

The role of the speakers was prominent during communal violence, when they were able to control the legislature from making provocative speeches or even debating the issue. It was also the speakers who influenced the executive to expedite the bureaucratic process in tackling land-grabbing issues, and who were instrumental in confronting the executive by impeaching the CTU (Nardi 2012). While their powers were absolute, they were instrumental in resolving conflicts. For instance, through their shepherding, the nature of the debate on communal violence changed from making emotional speeches to finding solutions. During the Rakhine conflict the discussion had focused on either the Rakhine–Muslim dynamic or the necessity of ensuring rule of law and security in conflict-affected areas, but during the Meiktila violence, the debate was more on the lack of co-ordination between the parliament and the government and finding ways to improve the rule of law.